TRISTAN (OLIVIER) BALMOKUNE, Immersive Media Designer & Educator

Calgary, AB, Canada | https://www.olytron.com

SUMMARY

Creative technologist and educator specializing in immersive storytelling, XR development, and learning experience design. MFA-trained in Film & Media Arts with 15+ years of experience spanning virtual production, instructional design, motion graphics, and interactive media. Adept at transforming complex systems into intuitive, emotionally resonant experiences through real-time engines, narrative-driven design, and cinematic visual language. A proven collaborator across industry, academia, and R&D, bringing a principled focus on usability, ethics, accessibility, and measurable learning and engagement outcomes.

EDUCATION

Information Technology Diploma | Southern Albert Institute of Technology

Bachelor of Media Arts and Digital Technologies | Alberta University of the Arts

Master of Fine Arts (Film & Media Arts) | University of Windsor | Oct 2023

EXPERIENCE

AI Cinematographer Consultant | Micro 1 | Jan 2026 - Present

- Consultant for and training for artificial intelligence cinematography. Expertise covers technical and creative aspects.
- Consultant for ai generated 360 video, storytelling, and short-form social media content

Video Editor / Post-Production Artist | Media Street Productions | Apr 2024 – Present

Edited and produced multi-platform video and animated content to support promotional and informational campaigns for diverse clients. Delivered motion graphics and edits that increased audience engagement and drove cross department interest following measurable performance improvements on social platforms.

- Edited and assembled multi-platform video content, improving narrative clarity and audience engagement through pacing, motion graphics, and sound design.
- Produced animated promotional content, increasing social media engagement as demonstrated by performance upticks that led additional departments to request animation support.
- Wrote concise, audience-specific copy, supporting effective communication across promotional and corporate media.

Sessional Professor | St. Clair College | Aug 2023 – May 2024

Designed and taught immersive storytelling courses in AR, VR, and 360° video, guiding students through scaffolded projects that progressively built technical, narrative, and collaborative skills. Developed evaluation rubrics and led group-based productions to ensure clear learning outcomes, ethical design practices, and professional-level project execution.

- Designed and delivered two immersive storytelling courses per term (approximately 40 students total), guiding learners through AR, VR, and 360° video production using scaffolded curricula.
- Led four progressive projects per course, strengthening narrative, technical, and collaborative skills, by structuring each project to build on prior storytelling and production competencies.
- Supervised group-based AR, VR, and 360 journalism projects, improving production quality and teamwork, through milestone-based feedback and critique.
- Developed grading rubrics and evaluation criteria, increasing clarity and consistency in assessment by aligning outcomes with storytelling effectiveness, usability, and technical execution.
- Introduced emerging technologies and AI-assisted workflows, expanding student creative confidence and critical awareness, through guided experimentation and ethical discussion.

XR Developer / VR Designer | Hitachi North America (R&D) | Jun 2022 – Aug 2023

Designed and built immersive VR and mixed-reality simulations for industrial training, architecture, and safety applications, enabling trainees to gain operational familiarity off-site and reduce on-site onboarding time. Integrated real-time engines, spatial interaction design, and AI-driven avatars to create realistic, scalable experiences that improved engagement, usability, and instructional clarity.

- Designed and built six immersive VR/MR prototypes, expanding internal XR capabilities across safety training, architecture, real estate, and industrial simulation, by developing real-time experiences for Meta Quest 2, Quest Pro, and HoloLens 2 using Unity and Unreal Engine.
- Created large-scale interactive simulations (oil & gas hazard training, warehouse layouts, automotive assembly), improving training readiness and situational understanding, by combining spatial design, scripted logic, and cinematic staging.
- Designed immersive XR training environments, reducing on-site onboarding time by giving trainees off-site familiarity with equipment and operations through realistic interaction workflows and guided scenarios.
- Developed a real-time AI-powered 3D avatar, increasing engagement and conversational relevance, by integrating GPT-driven dialogue with rigged characters and real-time lip sync.
- Evaluated and refined AI-driven avatar dialogue, reducing hallucinations and off-topic responses, by restructuring prompts and supplying robust domain specific data on manufacturing processes.
- Authored technical documentation and tutorials, improving stakeholder adoption and understanding, by translating complex XR systems into clear instructional materials.

Video Editor / Multimedia Producer | Getty Images Inc. | Dec 2008 – Oct 2022

Produced motion graphics, video, and instructional media for global audiences, supporting platform adoption, marketing initiatives, and internal communications at scale. Led end-to-end production workflows and redesigned internal pipelines, reducing costs while improving efficiency, clarity, and consistency across multimedia outputs.

- Produced motion graphics, video, and multimedia content for global marketing, training, and internal communications, supporting audiences of thousands of contributors worldwide and hundreds of internal employees.
- Created training and instructional media that enabled contributors to fully adopt a new submission platform within days, by aligning storytelling with user workflows and platform requirements.
- Led end-to-end video production workflows, delivering projects on time and on budget through hands-on direction, editing, and post-production.
- Redesigned an outsourced media production pipeline, reducing production costs by approximately 50
- 60% by transitioning to an internal, transparent workflow.
- Delivered over a dozen workshops for internal and external stakeholders, improving technical literacy and compliance across production workflows, composition, postproduction, and copyright best practices.

Educator / Graduate Assistant | University of Windsor | Jun 2020 – May 2022

Delivered undergraduate instruction and workshops in interactive narrative design and media production while

mentoring students in both classroom and lab environments. Modernized equipment management by replacing a manual booking system with a real-time digital workflow, significantly reducing errors and improving accountability for large-scale student projects.

- Delivered undergraduate lectures on interactive narrative design to cohorts of approximately 42 students, teaching environmental storytelling, agency, and presence through lectures and applied exercises.
- Developed and led an online photography workshop for over 60 participants, improving technical literacy through accessible, step-by-step instruction.
- Replaced a non-functional manual equipment booking system, reducing double-bookings, errors, and missing equipment by over 86%, by designing a real-time online inventory system supporting 400+ items.
- Enabled students to book equipment online and faculty to track availability, improving accountability and large-project coordination through transparent, professional workflows.
- Mentored 50+ students per term across classroom and lab environments, strengthening technical proficiency and exam readiness through hands-on supervision and feedback.
- Supervised and coordinated a team of five technicians, ensuring equipment reliability through structured maintenance and firmware update processes.

AWARDS

Visual Arts and New Media Individual Project Funding | Alberta Foundation for the Arts |

Film and Video Individual Project Grant | Alberta Foundation for the Arts |

AMPIA Nominee | Alberta Media Production Industries Association |

RBC EPIC Founders Pitch Second Place | RBC EPIC Founders |

Windsor Endowment for the Arts Grant | Windsor Endowment for the Arts |

CERTIFICATIONS

ChatGPT Advanced Data Analysis Certificate. | Vanderbilt University. | Jan 2026

Fundamentals of Data Visualization Certificate. | University of Colorado | Jan 2026

Google Data Analytics Certificate. | Google Inc. | Jan 2026

Google IT Automation with Python Certificate. | Google Inc. | Jan 2026

Epic Games Game Design Professional Certificate. | Epic Games. | Jan 2026

Google AI Essentials Certification. | Google Inc. | Jan 2025

SKILLS & ABILITIES

Immersive Media, XR & Interactive Storytelling

- Unreal Engine (Blueprints, Sequencer, Niagara, UMG)
- Unity (C#, XR Interaction Toolkit, MRTK)
- Spatial UI

- VR/AR Prototyping
- Interactive Narrative Design
- Worldbuilding
- Real-Time Virtual Production
- Virtual Cinematography
- AI-Driven Characters

Instructional Design, Education & Learning Technologies

- Curriculum Design
- Microlearning
- Gamification
- Technical Documentation
- LMS (Brightspace, Blackboard, SharePoint)
- SCORM/xAPI
- Instructional Design
- Accessibility (Universal Design for Learning – UDL)
- Assessment & Rubrics
- Learning Management Systems (LMS)
- Brightspace
- Blackboard
- SharePoint (LMS / Knowledge Management)
- Teaching (Adult & Higher Education)
- Student Engagement
- Multilingual Learning Support

Creative, Technical & Digital Production Skills

- Motion Graphics
- Animation
- Video Editing
- Cinematic Storytelling
- Virtual Cinematography
- 3D Asset Creation
- Compositing
- Visual Effects
- Visual Effects (VFX)
- Storyboarding
- Visual Design
- Typography
- Infographics
- Data Visualization
- Dashboard Design

AI & Emerging Technology

- Prompt Engineering
- Conversational UX
- Human–AI Interaction Evaluation
- AI-Assisted Cinematography

- ChatGPT and AI Tooling
- AI-Assisted Content Evaluation

Collaboration & Leadership

- Project Management
- Cross-Disciplinary Collaboration
- Stakeholder Communication
- Mentorship
- Research-Driven Design

Tools & Technologies

- Unreal Engine
- Unity
- Blender
- DaVinci Resolve
- HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- SharePoint
- Motion Capture
- Adobe Creative Cloud (After Effects, Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator)
- Figma
- TikTok
- macOS
- Windows
- Data Conversion

Tabletop Roleplaying Game Master & Interactive Facilitation

- Tabletop Roleplaying Game Facilitation (In-Person & Online)
- Improvised Real-Time Storytelling
- Convention & Demo Game Leadership
- Youth & Educational Game Instruction

Communication, Collaboration & Creative Strategy

- Strategic Communication
- Copywriting
- Brand Management
- Ideation
- Stakeholder Communication
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Interpersonal Communication
- Relationship Management
- Constructive Feedback
- Mentorship
- Research-Driven Design

Project Management, Process & Professional Effectiveness

- Agile Methodology
- Project & Production Management

- Budget Management
- Planning & Time Management
- Deadline Management
- Organizational Skills
- Detail-Oriented
- Analytical Thinking
- Problem Solving

LANGUAGES

French: Limited Working

AFFILIATIONS

Golden Key International Honour Society